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**r/GooglePixel** • 5mo ago

StephenAfamO Pixel 7 Pro

On 7 years of Updates

I remember when Google first announced this with the Pixel 8, a loud section of the internet tried to make this sound like a bad thing, saying the phones won't hold up.

It's been 2 years since then, and the phones seem to be holding up just fine. I am currently using a Pixel 7 Pro (since launch) and 3 years later, it is just as smooth as when I first got it. 4-year Pixel 6 owners would likely say the same, and even a [Pixel 4 owner](#) says the phone still feels fine.

The criticism always baffled me. Long before the Pixel 8, it should be obvious that even mid-range phones have enough hardware to remain usable for 7 years. **Obviously** the battery will degrade and may need replacement, and not every feature will be supported on an older device, but to say that the phones wouldn't hold up in 7 years felt very strange.

Still 5 more years for Google to prove me wrong, but I see no reason why 7 years of day-one updates would be unachievable. Kudos to Google for pioneering this.

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[github.com](#)[Join the conversation](#)Sort by: **Best** [Search Comments](#)**kwadguy** • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

I've never had a phone I wanted to use for seven years, and probably never will.

That said, I've had plenty of Samsung/Motorola phones that I was still happy with, except that they stopped getting updates. This is increasingly true. I mean, the Samsung S21 series (to take one example) got its last OS update in April, and that's still a very competent/useful/usable phone.

So do I need a full seven years? No. Do I like the fact that I no longer have to worry that my phone will get abandoned before I'm through with it? Yes, definitely.

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**Strangy1234** • 5mo ago

I would've kept using my OnePlus 8 if it got 7 years of updates. They stopped security updates after 4 years. Phone performance is great. Battery isn't terrible but could be replaced.

**Alternative_Neat3024** • 5mo ago

I am still on OnePlus 8 as well. Battery is not the best yeah but it still works very good.

**H0robOD1** • 5mo ago

Still rocking my OnePlus 8 Pro 5 years on, but installed LineageOS as soon as it reached end of life to have the latest OS and security patches. Still a very snappy phone. It's been a slightly janky experience using a custom ROM, so I'm leaning towards a Pixel for my next device purely for the extended software support.

**Strangy1234** • 5mo ago

I only got the Pixel 10 because T-Mobile was offering it for free. I bought an S10e on eBay for \$100 and traded it in. Getting a \$100 Costco gift card too to cover the \$100 I paid for the trade phone. Too good a deal to pass up.

**H0robOD1** • 5mo ago

Yeah I'm waiting for some more compelling Google Fi deals to drop on the Pixel 10 series. Hopefully can stack something with some black Friday deals in November.

**kwadguy** • 5mo ago

My I got three s10es on eBay for 72 bucks each, traded those in on my three T-Mobile lines for \$800 credit towards a free pixel 10 with 24 Bill credits. I did the deal at Costco so I saved the \$35 activation charge and I'll get \$100 per line back. So with taxes and cost of the trade-in phones, I'm looking at roughly 23 bucks each for three brand new pixel 10s. At that price they can sit in a drawer until I need them.

**edwinc8811** • 5mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro

The important thing that people keep forgetting/ignoring is how this greatly benefits the secondhand market.

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ProcessBeginning5431 • 5mo ago

Exactly this, a long support extends a possible second life for the phone, either by giving it or selling it, especially with this economy where smartphones cost a lot and there's not a huge difference in terms of features or performance, many people would probably rather buy a second hand one with still few years of support ahead.

Koopa777 • 5mo ago

Most phones are supported 2 years floor usually 3. I sure as hell hope nothing degraded over only 2 years. Let's revisit this conversation in another 4 years and let's see how it's going. A 2 year assessment of this matter is worthless.

neutronstar_kilonova • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

P7(SO) + P3(Me) <- P1 <- N4 <- N3

What's with the naysaying again? Let's revisit in 4 more years you say?

I am myself on my Pixel 3 (128 GB) that I bought in December of 2018, in its 7th year of operation. And it's working fine! I didn't even replace the battery. Software is a tad bit glitchy as well as it stopped at A12 which was known to have bugs. I've commented on this subreddit about a couple of dozen times over the time if you want to see proof I've owned it all this while. Must say I'm not a heavy phone user except when traveling about 1 week in 3 months. And it's people like I who appreciate having 7 years of updates in my future phone (which I had full conviction would be a 10 Pro, but ironically I'm now leaning towards a refurbished OG pixel fold, but that's besides the point.)

Edit: I don't understand why original comment is getting upvoted when there is evidence available presently contrary to it. @the original commentor, will you delete your comment because I have giving evidence of a 7th year assesment of a Pixel? Or will you let it be because its easier to ignore evidence than to acknowledge it?

KINGGS • 5mo ago

Wasn't there a post earlier today about how well the Pixel 4 is holding up?

[deleted] • 5mo ago

Aurelink • 5mo ago

Pixel 9 Fold Top 1% Commenter

Hell my grandfather literally JUST changed from his Pixel 3a, which, besides a little battery health down, still holded up really well

im_not_here_ • 5mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro

[Skip to main content](#)[+](#) Create**mikeyd234** • 5mo ago

Pixel 6

Going on 4 years with my Pixel 6 and very glad they extended support for it, been loving the material 3 update. The phone still holds up fine performance wise only issue in the long term will be battery. I've stuck to 20-80 slow charging the whole time I've had it and my battery health is at 89% according to accubattery.

**Progressive_Trance** • 5mo ago

Pixel 2 4 Pixel 7 Pro

FWIW, I ran my battery into the ground (pixel 7 pro) 0-100 and then some whenever I needed it, plugged in overnight to 100 to start each day and I'm at 88% health.

Don't need to train your phone. Use it as little or as much as you need.

**josh91117** • 5mo ago

My 9 pro xl is at 91% already.. your phone is still new.

**nemik_** • 5mo ago

Pixel 5

**XmattbeeX** • 5mo ago

It's the battery that's the problem. My pixel 6 is still running wonderfully, but I've had to replace the battery once already after it became a spicy pillow, and the official replacement is starting to struggle too in under a year. 7 years without open heart surgery is very doubtful for any pixel model imo.

**portfoliooso** • 5mo ago

Pixel 8 Pro

My 8 Pro is holding up just fine. I was always a "get a new one every 2 years" person, but with the cost of everything these days, I just finished paying off the 8 Pro and it will be nice to have a break in payments. A 10 Pro/XL looks lovely, but it's not a necessity. If I replace the battery, it'll be as good as when it was brand new. The hardware was never cutting edge from day 1, but in the real world, performance is perfect for web browsing, music, videos, banking and light gaming.

I think if you have a 7 or later, they're still "good enough" unless money is no object and you want the latest and greatest. I had a 6 Pro and it was the worst phone I ever owned. After it broke more times that insurance would replace, I downgraded to the 5 and it was better. The 5 --> 8 Pro was very nice upgrade. I think if you skip a few generations, the wow factor of the upgrade increases. I remember being unfazed from my 4 --> 6 Pro (and the 6 series gave me hell)

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shipped a single upgrade.

Google is famous for empty promises and killing commercial products with abandon.

The criticism is more so that Googles word is worth nothing and promises are cheap, and I would never advise to purchases or use of their service on the back of longevity promises.



GazelleInitial2050 • 5mo ago

While you're correct. Google is very clear with their update schedules and/or reimbursement.

I'd put money on these devices getting their support and if they don't you'll be reimbursed.

Look at stadia, they shelved it but I got a full refund on the hardware and games and kept the controller and chromecast.

Look at the battery issues on older pixels. Annoying but my grandads 7a got him £350 from google a couple of months ago.

They're more than fair when it comes to this consumer protection side.



Jim777PS3 • 5mo ago

10 Pro XL

While you're correct. Google is very clear with their update schedules and/or reimbursement.

Google makes no promise of reimbursement for failure to update phones.

I'd put money on these devices getting their support and if they don't you'll be reimburse.

I also think they will get their updates. I don't know if I would bet that they will receive all features, but I do believe the OS number will increment itself 7 times and that the phones will remain secure.

Look at stadia, they shelved it but I got a full refund on the hardware and games and kept the controller and chromecast.

Google has sold many more pixel phones then they ever shipped Stadia kits. And frankly Stadia is one of the more resounding reasons to not trust Googles commitments.

They're more than fair when it comes to this consumer protection side.

I would rather companies not have to do make goods in the first place, rather then try to argue on how "good" their make goods are.

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breaks or sinks before that but we'll see. Couple battery replacements are mandatory I guess

[u/BiscottiDisastrous19](#) • Promoted

Architecture-Independent Behavioral Detection in LLMs: 217K-Parameter Probes Achieve 999x Separation on Both Transformers and Mamba

[T_R_A_O_D](#) • 5mo ago

I don't know about pixels but I'm sure my s23 will last me at least 5 years haha.

[josh91117](#) • 5mo ago

It was Apple's biggest selling point yet when android phones extended the support people were hating on it lol. Makes no sense. When i traded in my note 9 did a factory reset and honestly the phone was incredibly smooth. A phone like that with 7 years of OS updates would have been amazing.

With a new battery I wouldn't have minded using it for more time.

A pixel 5 is another one i wish it had more support. Replacing the battery soon on it and im definitely keeping that one for as long as i can.

[tochichiang](#) • 5mo ago

I hadn't paid much attention to my old Pixel 6. One day, I checked the OS and, to my surprise, it was running Android 16. That's when I learned the Pixel 6 was extended to 5 years of OS and security updates. And I know there will be another OS upgrade next year.

[xLoneStar](#) • 5mo ago

A critical thing people are missing is that extended device support means I can give my phone to my parents or family members (who don't need the latest and greatest), with the phone still having support for a long time.

They don't care about the phone feeling snappy, nor any new feature. But will be the most vulnerable to vulnerability in software. So this is a huge win imo.

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**GazelleInitial2050** • 5mo ago

My dad has my old Pixel 6. Which is now starting its 5th year.

It's actually still more than fast enough for him and could easily see him having it for 3-4 more years without any issues (apart from it's not getting updates).

It's still WAY better than the cheap £150 motorolas he'd usually buy.

**horatiobanz** • 5mo ago • Edited 5mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

No, we said that 7 years was misleading because Google would withhold features from old devices. And they have.

Here is a thread from today talking about

it:https://www.reddit.com/r/GooglePixel/comments/1n81etn/pixel_8_pro_owners_lets_accept_the_fact_that_we/

The idea that the phones wouldn't hold up came later, as the phones didn't hold up. How can you possibly argue the phones are holding up as every single model they release has catastrophic hardware issues? Yes, Google replaces the phones when they are in warranty, but once out of warranty they tell you to fuck yourself. The Pixel 8 Pro's are losing WiFi and Bluetooth permanently starting a year ago. Every day there are posts from users begging for help with this issue. Pixel 8 and 9 series displays are goobered with vertical lines and green screens. Buttons are falling off of various models. Batteries are exploding. Camera bars are falling off. Is this indicative of a phone which is gonna last 7 years? And back to the battery, they have to auto gimp them now because they are using the cheapest shittiest batteries on the market. There is 0% chance a modern Pixel battery lasts 7 years.

**SilentLock** • 5mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

I'd be more worried of the hardware holding up. From my own experience, my Pixel 7 pro screen touches caused restarts, my Pixel 5 screen died, my Pixel 4a5G's power button was stuck and would cause re-boots. Not to mention all the battery issues (not just general degradation) that have cropped up in recent months

**Just_checking_92** • 5mo ago

Seems like you are the problem, hahaha.

**gasparthehaunter** • 5mo ago

Top 1% Commenter

it's not impossible, I have had my last device for 6 years (mi 9t pro) and my dad still has a redmi note 7. Not even flagships, yet with custom roms they work well. I changed mine because the original battery

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)**Just_checking_92** • 5mo ago

The Galaxy S10 is already 6.5 years old and works perfectly. 7 years should be mandatory because it creates unnecessary e-waste.

**Just_checking_92** • 5mo ago

The Galaxy S10 and the Iphone 11 are almost 7 years old. They work perfectly fine. 7 years of support is necessary.

**bmanlikeberry** • 5mo ago

Had my pixel XL for 6 years until I cracked the screen. Loved that phone.

**zendorClegane** • 5mo ago

Usable is a loose term since everyone considers it differently, I can still use my Nexus 5. Will it be pleasant and smooth? Obviously not, but it's usable.

**Ultimatum_Game** • 5mo ago

The duality of reddit is people complaining a phone won't be supported beyond 7 years but also complaining that this years Pixel 10 line isn't that different from last years Pixel 9 line and they don't see a reason to upgrade.

**PenteonianKnights** • 5mo ago**Pixel 10 Pro XL**

Free AI Pro is the new updates-support life. Yes I've now been 100% suckered in to yearly upgrades. I have succumbed to consumerism

**Eunapius** • 5mo ago

I've been very happy with my Pixel 6. I know I'm probably in the minority here but it has never given me major problems. Battery is starting to get bad, but that's a relatively cheap fix. I'm upgrading this year because I want to, not because I need to. My mom is unhappy with her cheapo Motorola she got last year so I plan on letting her try my P6 out. I bet the it will be a major upgrade for her even with the reduced battery life.

[Skip to main content](#)[Create](#)**Heas_Heartfire** • 5mo ago

Pixel 6

I mean, my former oneplus 6 is still going strong, just needed a single battery replacement when I switched to my current pixel 6. That was about four years ago.

So yeah, phones can last 7 years, and even more. Specially if you are like my mom and don't give a crap about the latest features.

**igokith** • 5mo ago

I still have my pixel 4a, it's still quite snappy. The only problem is the swelling battery

**Fade_ssud11** • 5mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

To be fair, 2 years isn't enough to make these judgments. We need to wait at least 4 years.

**StephenAfamO** **OP** • 5mo ago

Pixel 7 Pro

Pixel 6 users are about to begin their 5th year with the first gen tensor chip and it's holding up very well.

I can't imagine the Tensor G3 would hold up worse

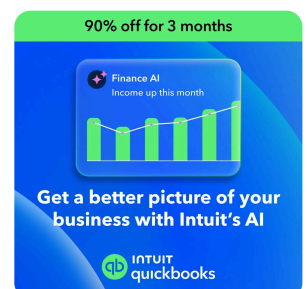
**Fade_ssud11** • 5mo ago

Pixel 9 Pro XL

My wife's pixel 6 started to overheat and slow down pretty much 2-3 a day, she eventually had to upgrade. But it was a refurbished unit so maybe that was why. I hope Google's optimisation is good enough with the later models to do the normal tasks smoothly for 4-5 years at least.

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One platform to run your business smarter

[Sign Up](#)quickbooks.intuit.com**Random_Dad** • 5mo ago

Pixel 8

[Skip to main content](#)[+ Create](#)**shadysage** • 5mo ago

Pixel 6a

You can't justify mid hardware lasting 7 years, look at the elite flagships and how they feel slow after a couple years.

By 4-5 years certain features/pixel drops aren't going to work on your device, due to it being outdated.

**StephenAfamO** OP • 5mo ago

Pixel 7 Pro

Pixel 6 is about to begin its 5th year.

Of course not all new features can be supported on the phone, but the phone works just as well as it did 4 years ago.

**shadysage** • 5mo ago

Pixel 6a

It doesn't work as well as it did 4 years ago lol, and trust me your phone is going to feel so dull with no new features. Lost its entire pixel identity.

**StephenAfamO** OP • 5mo ago

Pixel 7 Pro

Are you using a Pixel 6? Why do you say it doesn't work as well?

The Pixel 6 just got the September update with M3E and all the "freshness" how has it lost its identity?

If you always want the latest and greatest, then that's fine. But that doesn't mean the phone isn't being well supported for the promised 7 years.

**Aikon_94** • 5mo ago**Efficaciousuave** • 5mo ago

Pixel 7 Pro

I'm perfectly happy with all aspects of my pixel 7 pro and don't feel the need to upgrade either. Except for the frequent "your device needs to cool down" error messages and the below average battery life 😞. May be I should try getting the battery replaced

**gbroon** • 5mo ago

Same here. I used to regularly upgrade every two years. Now three years later I am still happy and have not seen any phone that really has anything that gets me excited to upgrade yet.

[+](#) Create

year for the first time, trying to improve photo quality I changed pro settings and when I try to take many shots in a row it freezes

**ericsson44** • 5mo ago

Ex Pixel 6 user here, I would agree, the phone was perfectly lag free and as smooth to use as it was on day 1, actually pixels actually get to the peak of performance and being bug free after 1 year of launch 🤪

**AssistantPretend8287** • 5mo ago

I personally must have the "LATEST and Greatest" at all times. But YeaH 👍

**Born_Maestro** • 5mo ago**TankHatesYou** • 5mo ago

Same. Using Pixel 7 Pro with the latest update phone feels "new" and yeah the battery is obviously somewhat worse but still enjoying the Pixel 7 Pro. If I switch it would be out of just wanting the newest tech but there's nothing really out there making me wanna buy it asap.

**Ornery-Squirrel-5489** • 5mo ago

Unfortunately my pixel 7 pro developed a GPS fault after 2 years otherwise I'd have kept it! Hopefully my 10 pro can last longer as I really don't feel that phones need upgrading every 2 years

**songsfortheDead1** • 5mo ago

If my OnePlus 3t and 6t had that level of updates and battery degradation wasn't a thing I would have used them for as long as possible.

The pixel 7 pro I'm currently using I've got no urgent plans to upgrade from. I'm probably getting the Ten but this thing is still smooth